

The Satyricon — Volume 04 : Escape by Sea

Petronius Arbiter

The background of the lower half of the page is a dark blue field filled with a complex, repeating pattern of bright blue geometric shapes. These shapes include various sizes of triangles, squares, rectangles, and lines, some of which are arranged to form larger, more intricate patterns like a stylized 'X' or a 'Z'. The pattern is dense and covers the entire lower half of the page.

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The Satyricon — Volume 04 : Escape by Sea

Petronius Arbiter

An abstract geometric pattern on a dark blue background. It features various shapes in a vibrant magenta color, including triangles, squares, rectangles, and lines. Some shapes are solid, while others are outlines. The pattern is dense and non-repeating, creating a complex visual texture.

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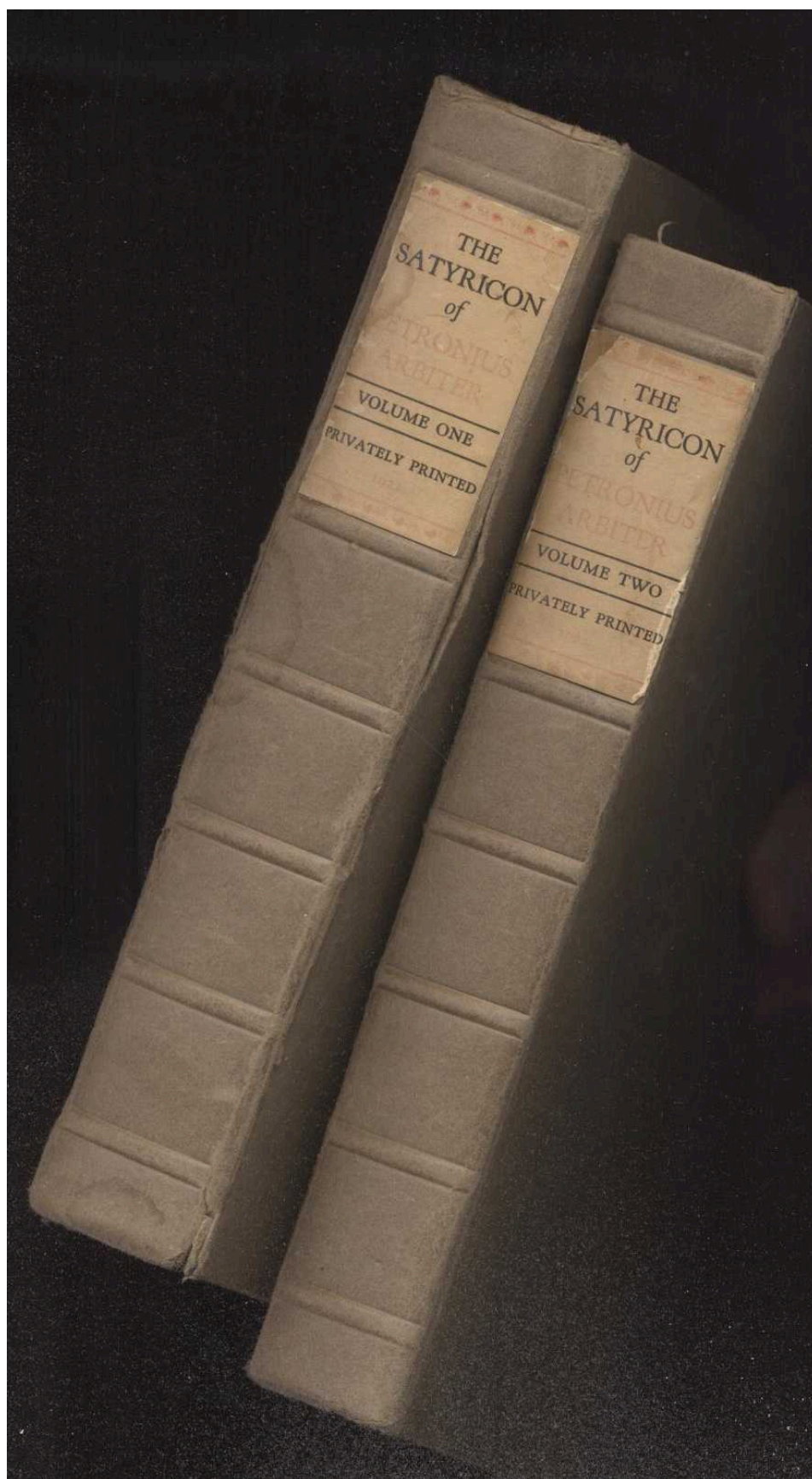
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SATYRICON — VOLUME 04 : ESCAPE BY SEA ***

THE SATYRICON OF
PETRONIUS ARBITER

Volume 4.



*Complete and unexpurgated
translation by W. C. Firebaugh, in
which are incorporated the forgeries
of Nodot and Marchena, and the
readings introduced into the text by
De Salas.*



The Witches (*page 138*)

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THE SATYRICON OF PETRONIUS ARBITER

Volume 4.

BRACKET CODE:

(Forgeries of Nodot)

[Forgeries of Marchena]

{Additions of De Salas}

DW

VOLUME IV.

ENCOLPIUS, GITON AND EUMOLPUS ESCAPE BY SEA



The Embarkation

CHAPTER THE NINETY-NINTH.

"I have always and everywhere lived such a life that each passing day was spent as though that light would never return; (that is, in tranquillity! Put aside those thoughts which worry you, if you wish to follow my lead. Ascyltos persecutes you here; get out of his way. I am about to start for foreign parts, you may come with me. I have taken a berth on a vessel which will probably weigh anchor this very night. I am well known on board, and we shall be well received.)

Leave then thy home and seek a
foreign shore
Brave youth; for thee thy destiny
holds more:
To no misfortune yield! The Danube
far
Shall know thy spirit, and the polar
star,
And placid Nile, and they who dwell
in lands
Where sunrise starts, or they where
sunset ends!
A new Ulysses treads on foreign
sands."

(To me, this advice seemed both sound and practical, because it would free me from any annoyance by Ascyltos, and because it gave promise of a happier life. I was overcome by the kindly sympathy of Eumolpus, and was especially sorry for the latest injury I had done him. I began to repent my jealousy, which had been the cause of so many unpleasant happenings) and with many tears, I begged and pled with him to admit me into favor, as lovers cannot control their furious jealousy, and vowing, at the same time,

that I would not by word or deed give him cause for offense in the future. And he, like a learned and cultivated gentleman, ought to remove all irritation from his mind, and leave no trace of it behind. The snows belong upon the ground in wild and uncultivated regions, but where the earth has been beautified by the conquest of the plough, the light snow melts away while you speak of it. And so it is with anger in the heart; in savage minds it lingers long, it glides quickly away from the cultured. "That you may experience the truth of what you say," exclaimed Eumolpus, "see! I end my anger with a kiss. May good luck go with us! Get your baggage together and follow me, or go on ahead, if you prefer." While he was speaking, a knock sounded at the door, and a sailor with a bristling beard stood upon the threshold. "You're hanging in the wind, Eumolpus," said he, "as if you didn't know that son-of-a-bitch of a skipper!" Without further delay we all got up. Eumolpus ordered his servant, who had been asleep for some time, to bring his baggage out. Giton and I pack together whatever we have for the voyage and, after praying to the stars, we went aboard.

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDREDTH.

(We picked out a retired spot on the poop and Eumolpus dozed off, as it was not yet daylight. Neither Giton nor myself could get a wink of sleep, however. Anxiously I reflected that I had received Eumolpus as a comrade, a rival more formidable than Ascylos, and that thought tortured me. But reason soon put my uneasiness to flight.) "It is unfortunate," (said I to myself,) "that the lad has so taken our friend's fancy, but what of it? Is not nature's every masterpiece common to all? The sun shines upon all alike! The moon with her innumerable train of stars lights even the wild beasts to their food. What can be more beautiful than water?

"Yet it flows for common use. Shall love alone, then, be stolen, rather than be regarded as a prize to be won? No, indeed I desire no possession unless the world envies me for possessing it. A solitary old man can scarcely become a serious rival; even should he wish to take advantage, he would lose it through lack of breath." When, but without any confidence, I had arrived at these conclusions, and beguiled my uneasy spirit, I covered my head with my tunic and began to feign sleep, when all of a sudden, as though Fortune were bent upon annihilating my peace of mind, a voice upon the ship's deck gritted out something like this--"So he fooled me after all."--As this voice, which was a man's, and was only too familiar, struck my ears, my heart fluttered. And then a woman, equally furious, spat out more spitefully still--"If only some god would put Giton into my hands, what a fine time I would give that runaway." --Stunned by these unexpected words, we both turned pale as death. I was completely terrified, and, as though I were enveloped in some turbulent nightmare, was a long time finding my voice, but at last, with trembling hands, I tugged at the hem of Eumolpus' clothing, just as he was sinking into slumber. "Father," I quavered, "on your word of honor, can you tell me whose ship this is, and whom she has aboard?" Peeved at being disturbed, "So," he snapped, "this was the reason you wished to have us quartered in the most inaccessible spot on deck, was it? So we could get no rest! What good will it do you

when I've informed you that Lycas of Tarentum is master of this ship and that he carries Tryphaena as an exile to Tarentum?"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND FIRST.

I shivered, horror-struck, at this thunderbolt and, beating my throat, "Oh Destiny," I wailed, "you've vanquished me completely, at last!" As for Giton, he fell in a faint upon my bosom and remained unconscious for quite a while, until a sweat finally relieved our tension, whereupon, hugging Eumolpus around the knees, "Take pity upon the perishing," I besought him, "in the name of our common learning, aid us! Death himself hangs over us, and he will come as a relief unless you help us!" Overwhelmed by this implication, Eumolpus swore by all the gods and goddesses that he knew nothing of what had happened, nor had he had any ulterior purpose in mind, but that he had brought his companions upon this voyage which he himself had long intended taking, with the most upright intentions and in the best of good faith. "But," demanded he, "what is this ambush? Who is this Hannibal who sails with us? Lycas of Tarentum is a most respectable citizen and the owner, not only of this ship, which he commands in person, but of landed estates as well as commercial houses under the management of slaves. He carries a cargo consigned to market. He is the Cyclops, the arch-pirate, to whom we owe our passage! And then, besides himself, there is Tryphaena, a most charming woman, travelling about here and there in search of pleasure." "But," objected Giton, "they are the very ones we are most anxious to avoid," whereupon he explained to the astonished Eumolpus the reasons for their enmity and for the danger which threatened us. So muddled did he become, at what had been told him, that he lost the power of thinking, and requested each of us to offer his own opinion. "Just imagine," said he, "that we are trapped in the Cyclops' cave: some way out must be found, unless we bring about a shipwreck, and free ourselves from all dangers!" "Bribe the pilot, if necessary, and persuade him to steer the ship into some port," volunteered Giton; "tell him your brother's nearly dead from seasickness: your woebegone face and streaming tears will lend color to your deception, and the pilot may be moved to mercy and grant your prayer." Eumolpus denied the practicability of this. "It is only with difficulty," affirmed he, "that large ships are warped into landlocked

harbors, nor would it appear probable that my brother could have been taken so desperately in so short a time. And then, Lycas will be sure to want to visit a sick passenger, as part of his duties! You can see for yourselves what a fine stroke it would be, bringing the captain to his own runaways! But, supposing that the ship could be put off her course, supposing that Lycas did not hold sick-call, how could we leave the ship in such a manner as not to be stared at by all the rest? With muffled heads? With bare? If muffled, who would not want to lend the sick man a hand? If bare, what would it mean if not proscribing ourselves?"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND SECOND.

"Why would it not be better to take refuge in boldness," I asked, "slide down a rope into the ship's boat, cut the painter, and leave the rest to luck'? And furthermore, I would not involve Eumolpus in this adventure, for what is the good of getting an innocent man into troubles with which he has no concern? I shall be well content if chance helps us into the boat." "Not a bad scheme," Eumolpus agreed, "if it could only be carried out: but who could help seeing you when you start? Especially the man at the helm, who stands watch all night long and observes even the motions of the stars. But it could be done in spite of that, when he dozed off for a second, that is, if you chose some other part of the ship from which to start: as it is, it must be the stern, you must even slip down the rudder itself, for that is where the painter that holds the boat in tow is made fast. And there is still something else, Encolpius. I am surprised that it has not occurred to you that one sailor is on watch, lying in the boat, night and day. You couldn't get rid of that watchman except by cutting his throat or throwing him overboard by force. Consult your own courage as to whether that can be done or not. And as far as my coming with you is concerned, I shirk no danger which holds out any hopes of success, but to throw away life without a reason, as if it were a thing of no moment, is something which I do not believe that even you would sanction--see what you think of this: I will wrap you up in two hide baggage covers, tie you up with thongs, and stow you among my clothing, as baggage, leaving the ends somewhat open, of course, so you can breathe and get your food. Then I will raise a hue and cry because my slaves have thrown themselves into the sea, fearing worse punishment; and when the ship makes port, I will carry you out as baggage without exciting the slightest suspicion!" "Oh! So you would bundle us up like we were solid," I sneered; "our bellies wouldn't make trouble for us, of course, and we'll never sneeze nor snore! And all because a similar trick turned out successfully before! Think the matter over! Being tied up could be endured

for one day, but suppose it might have to be for longer? What if we should be becalmed? What if we were struck by a storm from the wrong quarter of the heavens? What could we do then? Even clothes will cut through at the wrinkles when they are tied up too long, and paper in bundles will lose its shape. Do you imagine that we, who are young and unused to hardship, could endure the filthy rags and lashings necessary to such an operation, as statues do? No! That's settled! Some other road to safety must be found! I have thought up a scheme, see what you think of it! Eumolpus is a man of letters. He will have ink about him, of course. With this remedy, then, let's change our complexions, from hair to toe-nails! Then, in the guise of Ethiopian slaves, we shall be ready at hand to wait upon you, light-hearted as having escaped the torturer, and, with our altered complexions, we can impose upon our enemies!" "Yes, indeed," sneered Giton, "and be sure and circumcise us, too, so we will be taken for Jews, pierce our ears so we will look like Arabs, chalk our faces so that Gaul will take us for her own sons; as if color alone could change one's figure! As if many other details did not require consideration if a passable imposture is to result! Even granting that the stained face can keep its color for some time, suppose that not a drop of water should spot the skin, suppose that the garment did not stick to the ink, as it often does, where no gum is used, tell me! We can't make our lips so hideously thick, can we? We can't kink our hair with a curling-iron, can we? We can't harrow our foreheads with scars, can we? We can't force our legs out into the form of a bow or walk with our ankle-bones on the ground, can we? Can we trim our beards after the foreign style? No! Artificial color dirties the body without changing it. Listen to the plan which I have thought out in my desperation; let's tie our garments around our heads and throw ourselves into the deep!"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND THIRD.

"Gods and men forbid that you should make so base an ending of your lives," cried Eumolpus. "No! It will be better to do as I direct. As you may gather, from his razor, my servant is a barber: let him shave your heads and eyebrows, too, and quickly at that! I will follow after him, and I will mark my inscription so cleverly upon your foreheads that you will be mistaken for slaves who have been branded! The same letters will serve both to quiet the suspicions of the curious and to conceal, under semblance of punishment, your real features!" We did not delay the execution of this scheme but, sneaking stealthily to the ship's side, we submitted our heads and eyebrows to the barber, that he might shave them clean. Eumolpus covered our foreheads completely, with large letters and, with a liberal hand, spread the universally known mark of the fugitive over the face of each of us. As luck would have it, one of the passengers, who was terribly seasick, was hanging over the ship's side easing his stomach. He saw the barber busy at his unseasonable task by the light of the moon and, cursing the omen which resembled the last offering of a crew before shipwreck, he threw himself into his bunk. Pretending not to hear his puking curses, we reverted to our melancholy train of thought and, settling ourselves down in silence, we passed the remaining hours of the night in fitful slumber. (On the following morning Eumolpus entered Lycas' cabin as soon as he knew that Tryphaena was out of bed and, after some conversation upon the happy voyage of which the fine weather gave promise, Lycas turned to Tryphaena and remarked:)

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND FOURTH.

"Priapus appeared to me in a dream and seemed to say--Know that Encolpius, whom you seek, has, by me, been led aboard your ship!" Tryphaena trembled violently, "You would think we had slept together," she cried, "for a bust of Neptune, which I saw in the gallery at Baiae, said to me, in my dream--You will find Giton aboard Lycas' ship!" "From which you can see that Epicurus was a man inspired," remarked Eumolpus; "he passed sentence upon mocking phantasms of that kind in a very witty manner.

Dreams that delude the mind with
flitting shades
By neither powers of air nor gods, are
sent:
Each makes his own! And when
relaxed in sleep
The members lie, the mind, without
restraint
Can flit, and re-enact by night, the
deeds
That occupied the day. The warrior
fierce,
Who cities shakes and towns destroys
by fire
Maneuvering armies sees, and
javelins,
And funerals of kings and bloody
fields.

The cringing lawyer dreams of courts
and trials,
The miser hides his hoard, new
treasures finds:
The hunter's horn and hounds the
forests wake,
The shipwrecked sailor from his hulk
is swept.
Or, washed aboard, just misses
perishing.
Adulteresses will bribe, and harlots
write
To lovers: dogs, in dreams their hare
still course;
And old wounds ache most
poignantly in dreams!"

"Still, what's to prevent our searching the ship?" said Lycas, after he had expiated Tryphaena's dream, "so that we will not be guilty of neglecting the revelations of Providence?" "And who were the rascals who were being shaved last night by the light of the moon?" chimed in Hesus, unexpectedly, for that was the name of the fellow who had caught us at our furtive transformation in the night. "A rotten thing to do, I swear! From what I hear, it's unlawful for any living man aboard ship to shed hair or nails, unless the wind has kicked up a heavy sea."

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND FIFTH.

Lycas was greatly disturbed by this information, and flew into a rage. "So someone aboard my ship cut off his hair, did he?" he bawled, "and at dead of night, too! Bring the offenders aft on deck here, and step lively, so that I can tell whom to punish, from their heads, that the ship may be freed from the curse!" "I ordered it done," Eumolpus broke in, "and I didn't order it as an unlucky omen, either, seeing that I had to be aboard the same vessel: I did it because the scoundrels had long matted hair, I ordered the filth cleared off the wretches because I did not wish to even seem to make a prison out of your ship: besides, I did not want the seared scars of the letters to be hidden in the least, by the interference of the hair; as they ought to be in plain sight, for everyone to read, and at full length, too. In addition to their other misdemeanors, they blew in my money on a street-walker whom they kept in common; only last night I dragged them away from her, reeking with wine and perfumes, as they were, and they still stink of the remnants of my patrimony!" Thereupon, forty stripes were ordered for each of us, that the tutelary genius of the ship might be propitiated. And they were not long about it either. Eager to propitiate the tutelary genius with our wretched blood, the savage sailors rushed upon us with their rope's ends. For my part, I endured three lashes with Spartan fortitude, but at the very first blow, Giton set up such a howling that his all too familiar voice reached the ears of Tryphaena; nor was she the only one who was in a flutter, for, attracted by this familiar voice, all the maids rushed to where he was being flogged. Giton had already moderated the ardor of the sailors by his wonderful beauty, he appealed to his torturers without uttering a word. "It's Giton! It's Giton!" the maids all screamed in unison. "Hold your hands, you brutes; help, Madame, it's Giton!" Tryphaena turned willing ears, she had recognized that voice herself, and flew to the boy. Lycas, who knew me as well as if he had heard my voice, now ran up; he glanced at neither face nor hands, but directed his eyes towards parts lower down; courteously he shook hands with them, "How do you do, Encolpius," he said. Let no one be surprised at Ulysses' nurse discovering, after twenty years, the scar that

established his identity, since this man, so keenly observant, had, in spite of the most skillful disguise of every feature and the obliteration of every identifying mark upon my body, so surely hit upon the sole means of identifying his fugitive! Deceived by our appearance, Tryphaena wept bitterly, believing that the marks upon our foreheads were, in truth, the brands of prisoners: she asked us gently, into what slave's prison we had fallen in our wanderings, and whose cruel hands had inflicted this punishment. Still, fugitives whose members had gotten them into trouble certainly deserved some punishment.

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND SIXTH.

In a towering passion, Lycas leaped forward, "Oh you silly woman," he shouted, "as if those scars were made by the letters on the branding-iron! If only they had really blotched up their foreheads with those inscriptions, it would be some satisfaction to us, at least; but as it is, we are being imposed upon by an actor's tricks, and hoaxed by a fake inscription!" Tryphaena was disposed to mercy, as all was not lost for her pleasures, but Lycas remembered the seduction of his wife and the insults to which he had been subjected in the portico of the temple of Hercules: "Tryphaena," he gritted out, his face convulsed with savage passion, "you are aware, I believe, that the immortal gods have a hand in human affairs: what did they do but lead these scoundrels aboard this ship in ignorance of the owner and then warn each of us alike, by a coincidence of dreams, of what they had done? Can you then see how it would be possible to let off those whom a god has, himself, delivered up to punishment? I am not a cruel man; what moves me is this: I am afraid I shall have to endure myself whatever I remit to them!" At this superstitious plea Tryphaena veered around; denying that she would plead for quarter, she was even anxious to help along the fulfillment of this retribution, so entirely just: she had herself suffered an insult no less poignant than had Lycas, for her chastity had been called in question before a crowd.

Primeval Fear created Gods on earth
when from the sky
The lightning-flashes rent with flame
the ramparts of the world,
And smitten Athos blazed! Then,
Phoebus, sinking to the earth,
His course complete, and waning
Luna, offerings received.
The changing seasons of the year the

superstition spread
Throughout the world; and Ignorance
and Awe, the toiling boor,
To Ceres, from his harvest, the first
fruits compelled to yield
And Bacchus with the fruitful vine to
crown. Then Pales came
Into her own, the shepherd's gains to
share. Beneath the waves
Of every sea swims Neptune. Pallas
guards the shops,
And those impelled by Avarice or
Guilt, create new Gods!

(Lycas, as he perceived that Tryphaena was as eager as himself for revenge, gave orders for our punishment to be renewed and made more drastic, whereupon Eumolpus endeavored to appease him as follows,)

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND SEVENTH.

("Lycas," said he, "these unfortunates upon whom you intend to wreak your vengeance, implore your compassion and) have chosen me for this task. I believe that I am a man, by no means unknown, and they desire that, somehow, I will effect a reconciliation between them and their former friends. Surely you do not imagine that these young men fell into such a snare by accident, when the very first thing that concerns every prospective passenger is the name of the captain to whom he intrusts his safety! Be reasonable, then; forego your revenge and permit free men to proceed to their destination without injury. When penitence manages to lead their fugitives back, harsh and implacable masters restrain their cruelty, and we are merciful to enemies who have surrendered. What could you ask, or wish for, more? These well-born and respectable young men be suppliant before your eyes and, what ought to move you more strongly still, were once bound to you by the ties of friendship. If they had embezzled your money or repaid your faith in them with treachery, by Hercules, you have ample satisfaction from the punishment already inflicted! Look! Can you read slavery on their foreheads, and see upon the faces of free men the brand-marks of a punishment which was self-inflicted!" Lycas broke in upon this plea for mercy, "Don't try to confuse the issue," he said, "let every detail have its proper attention and first of all, why did they strip all the hair off their heads, if they came of their own free will? A man meditates deceit, not satisfaction, when he changes his features! Then again, if they sought reconciliation through a mediator, why did you do your best to conceal them while employed in their behalf? It is easily seen that the scoundrels fell into the toils by chance and that you are seeking some device by which you could sidestep the effects of our resentment. And be careful that you do not spoil your case by over-confidence when you attempt to sow prejudice among us by calling them well-born and respectable! What should the injured parties do when the guilty run into their own punishment? And

inasmuch as they were our friends, by that, they deserve more drastic punishment still, for whoever commits an assault upon a stranger, is termed a robber; but whoever assaults a friend, is little better than a parricide!" "I am well aware," Eumolpus replied, to rebut this damning harangue, "that nothing can look blacker against these poor young men than their cutting off their hair at night. On this evidence, they would seem to have come aboard by accident, not voluntarily. Oh how I wish that the explanation could come to your ears just as candidly as the thing itself happened! They wanted to relieve their heads of that annoying and useless weight before they came aboard, but the unexpected springing up of the wind prevented the carrying out of their wishes, and they did not imagine that it mattered where they began what they had decided to do, because they were unacquainted with either the omens or the law of seafaring men." "But why should they shave themselves like suppliants?" demanded Lycas, "unless, of course, they expected to arouse more sympathy as bald-pates. What's the use of seeking information through a third person, anyway? You scoundrel, what have you to say for yourself? What salamander singed off your eyebrows? You poisoner, what god did you vow your hair to? Answer!"



The Fight

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND EIGHTH.

I was stricken dumb, and trembled from fear of punishment, nor could I find anything to say, out of countenance as I was and hideous, for to the disgrace of a shaven poll was added an equal baldness in the matter of eyebrows; the case against me was only too plain, there was not a thing to be said or done! Finally, a damp sponge was passed over my tear-wet face, and thereupon, the smut dissolved and spread over my whole countenance, blotting out every feature in a sooty cloud. Anger turned into loathing. Swearing that he would permit no one to humiliate well-born young men contrary to right and law, Eumolpus checked the threats of the savage persecutors by word and by deed. His hired servant backed him up in his protest, as did first one and then another of the feeblest of the seasick passengers, whose participation served rather to inflame the disagreement than to be of help to us. For myself I asked no quarter, but I shook my fists in Tryphaena's face, and told her in a loud voice that unless she stopped hurting Giton, I would use every ounce of my strength against her, reprobate woman that she was, the only person aboard the ship who deserved a flogging. Lycas was furiously angry at my hardihood, nor was he less enraged at my abandoning my own cause, to take up that of another, in so wholehearted a manner. Inflamed as she was by this affront, Tryphaena was as furious as he, so the whole ship's company was divided into two factions. On our side, the hired barber armed himself with a razor and served out the others to us; on their side, Tryphaena's retainers prepared to battle with their bare fists, nor was the scolding of female warriors unheard in the battle-line. The pilot was neutral, but he declared that unless this madness, stirred up by the lechery of a couple of vagabonds, died down, he would let go the helm! The fury of the combatants continued to rage none the less fiercely, nevertheless, they fighting for revenge, we for life. Many fell on each side, though none were mortally wounded, and more, bleeding from wounds, retreated, as from a real battle, but the fury of

neither side abated. At last the gallant Giton turned the menacing razor against his own virile parts, and threatened to cut away the cause of so many misfortunes. This was too much for Tryphaena; she prevented the perpetration of so horrid a crime by the out and out promise of quarter. Time and time again, I lifted the barber's blade to my throat, but I had no more intention of killing myself than had Giton of doing what he threatened, but he acted out the tragic part more realistically than I, as it was, because he knew that he held in his hand the same razor with which he had already cut his throat. The lines still stood at the ready, and it was plain to be seen that this would be no everyday affair, when the pilot, with difficulty, prevailed upon Tryphaena to undertake the office of herald, and propose a truce; so, when pledges of good faith had been given and received, in keeping with the ancient precedent she snatched an olive-branch from the ship's figurehead and, holding it out, advanced boldly to parley.

"What fury," she exclaims, "turns
peace to war? What evil deed
Was by these hands committed?
Trojan hero there is none
Absconding in this ship with bride of
Atreus' cuckold seed
Nor crazed Medea, stained by life's
blood of her father's son!
But passion scorned, becomes a
power: alas! who courts his end
By drawing sword amidst these
waves? Why die before our time?
Strive not with angry seas to vie and
to their fury lend
Your rage by piling waves upon its
savage floods sublime !"

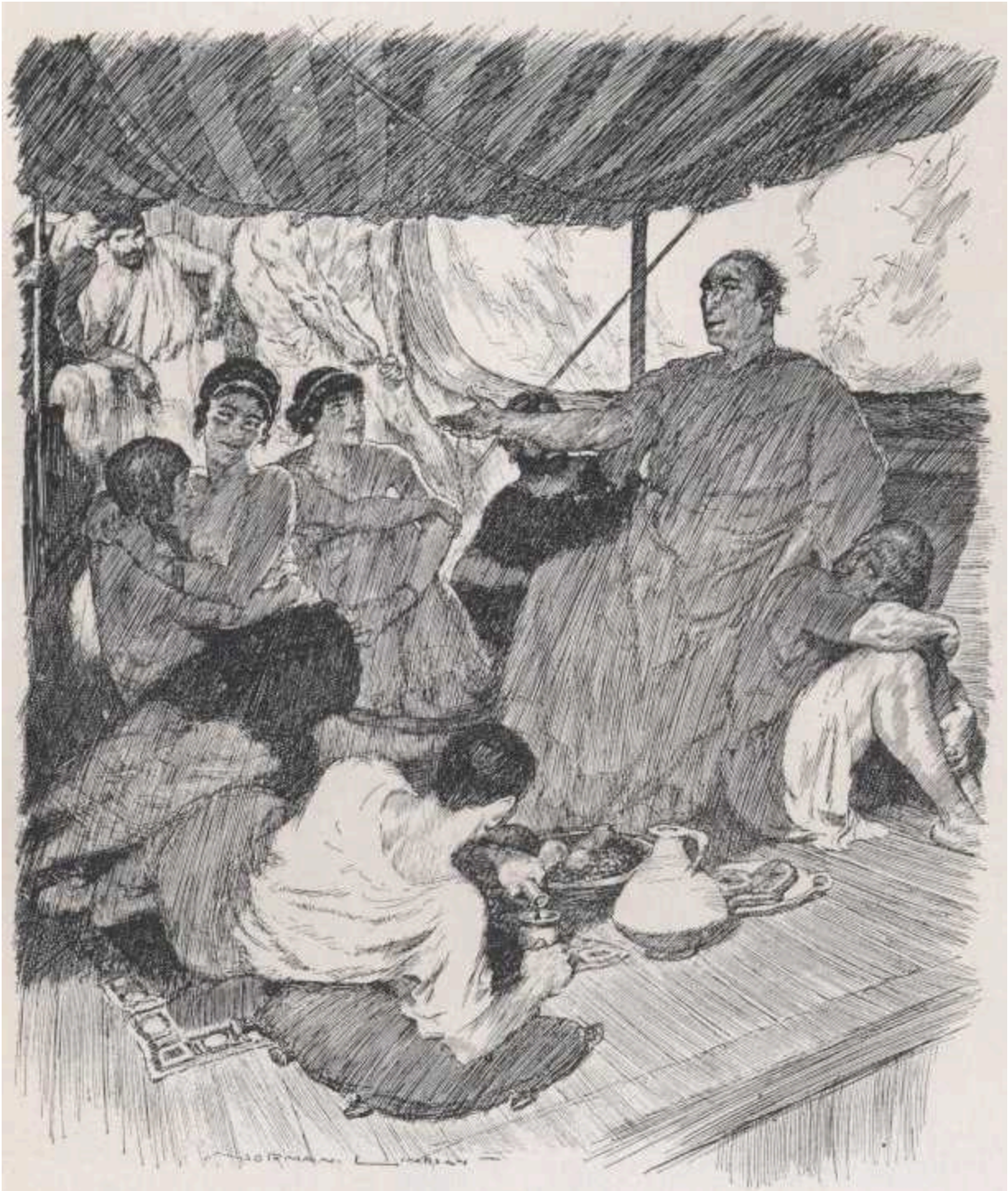
CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND NINTH.

The woman poured out this rhapsody in a loud excited voice, the battle-line wavered for an instant, then all hands were recalled to peace and terminated the war. Eumolpus, our commander, took advantage of the psychological moment of their repentance and, after administering a stinging rebuke to Lycas, signed a treaty of peace which was drawn up as follows: "It is hereby solemnly agreed on your part, Tryphaena, that you do forego complaint of any wrong done you by Giton; that you do not bring up anything that has taken place prior to this date, that you do not seek to revenge anything that has taken place prior to this date, that you do not take steps to follow it up in any other manner whatsoever; that you do not command the boy to perform anything to him repugnant; that you do neither embrace nor kiss the said Giton; that you do not enfold said Giton in the sexual embrace, except under immediate forfeiture of one hundred denarii. Item, it is hereby agreed on your part, Lycas, that you do refrain from annoying Encolpius with abusive word or reproachful look; that you do not seek to ascertain where he sleep at night; or, if you do so seek, that you forfeit two hundred denarii immediately for each and every such offense." The treaty was signed upon these terms, and we laid down our arms. It seemed well to wipe out the past with kisses, after we had taken oath, for fear any vestige of rancor should persist in our minds. Factious hatreds died out amidst universal good-fellowship, and a banquet, served on the field of battle, crowned our reconciliation with joviality. The whole ship resounded with song and, as a sudden calm had caused her to lose headway, one tried to harpoon the leaping fish, another hauled in the struggling catch on baited hooks. Then some sea-birds alighted upon the yard-arms and a skillful fowler touched them with his jointed rods: they were brought down to our hands, stuck fast to the limed segments. The breeze caught up the down, but the wing and tail feathers twisted spirally as they fell into the sea-foam. Lycas was already beginning to be on good terms with me, and Tryphaena had just sprinkled Giton with the last drops in her cup, when Eumolpus, who was himself almost drunk, was seized with the notion of

satirizing bald pates and branded rascals, but when he had exhausted his chilly wit, he returned at last to his poetry and recited this little elegy upon hair:

"Gone are those locks that to thy
beauty lent such lustrous charm
And blighted are the locks of Spring
by bitter Winter's sway;
Thy naked temples now in baldness
mourn their vanished form,
And glistens now that poor bare
crown, its hair all worn away
Oh! Faithless inconsistency! The
gods must first resume
The charms that first they granted
youth, that it might lovelier bloom!

Poor wretch, but late thy locks did
brighter glister
Than those of great Apollo or his
sister!
Now, smoother is thy crown than
polished grasses
Or rounded mushrooms when a
shower passes!
In fear thou fliest the laughter-loving
lasses.
That thou may'st know that Death is
on his way,
Know that thy head is partly dead this
day!"



Eumolpus Reciting

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TENTH.

It is my opinion that he intended favoring us with more of the same kind of stuff, sillier than the last, but Tryphaena's maid led Giton away below and fitted the lad out in her mistress' false curls; then producing some eyebrows from a vanity box, she skillfully traced out the lines of the lost features and restored him to his proper comeliness. Recognizing the real Giton, Tryphaena was moved to tears, and then for the first time she gave the boy a real love-kiss. I was overjoyed, now that the lad was restored to his own handsome self, but I hid my own face all the more assiduously, realizing that I was disfigured by no ordinary hideousness since not even Lycas would bestow a word upon me. The maid rescued me from this misfortune finally, however, and calling me aside, she decked me out with a head of hair which was none the less becoming; my face shone more radiantly still, as a matter of fact, for my curls were golden! But in a little while, Eumolpus, mouthpiece of the distressed and author of the present good understanding, fearing that the general good humor might flag for lack of amusement, began to indulge in sneers at the fickleness of women: how easily they fell in love; how readily they forgot even their own sons! No woman could be so chaste but that she could be roused to madness by a chance passion! Nor had he need to quote from old tragedies, or to have recourse to names, notorious for centuries; on the contrary, if we cared to hear it, he would relate an incident which had occurred within his own memory, whereupon, as we all turned our faces towards him and gave him our attention, he began as follows:



The Ephesian Matron

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND ELEVENTH.

"There was a certain married lady at Ephesus, once upon a time, so noted for her chastity that she even drew women from the neighboring states to come to gaze upon her! When she carried out her husband she was by no means content to comply with the conventional custom and follow the funeral cortege with her hair down, beating her naked breast in sight of the onlookers! She followed the corpse, even into the tomb; and when the body had been placed in the vault, in accordance with the Greek custom, she began to stand vigil over it, weeping day and night! Neither parents nor relations could divert her from punishing herself in this manner and from bringing on death by starvation. The magistrates, the last resort, were rebuffed and went away, and the lady, mourned by all as an unusual example, dragged through the fifth day without nourishment. A most faithful maid was in attendance upon the poor woman; she either wept in company with the afflicted one or replenished the lamp which was placed in the vault, as the occasion required. Throughout the whole city there was but one opinion, men of every calling agreed that here shone the one solitary example of chastity and of love! In the meantime the governor of the province had ordered some robbers crucified near the little vault in which the lady was bewailing her recent loss. On the following night, a soldier who was standing guard over the crosses for fear someone might drag down one of the bodies for burial, saw a light shining brightly among the tombs, and heard the sobs of someone grieving. A weakness common to mankind made him curious to know who was there and what was going on, so he descended into the tomb and, catching sight of a most beautiful woman, he stood still, afraid at first that it was some apparition or spirit from the infernal regions; but he finally comprehended the true state of affairs as his eye took in the corpse lying there, and as he noted the tears and the face lacerated by the finger-nails, he understood that the lady was unable to endure the loss of the dear departed. He then brought his own scanty ration

into the vault and exhorted the sobbing mourner not to persevere in useless grief, or rend her bosom with unavailing sobs; the same end awaited us all, the same last resting place: and other platitudes by which anguished minds are recalled to sanity. But oblivious to sympathy, she beat and lacerated her bosom more vehemently than before and, tearing out her hair, she strewed it upon the breast of the corpse. Notwithstanding this, the soldier would not leave off, but persisted in exhorting the unfortunate lady to eat, until the maid, seduced by the smell of the wine, I suppose, was herself overcome and stretched out her hand to receive the bounty of their host. Refreshed by food and drink, she then began to attack the obstinacy of her mistress. 'What good will it do you to die of hunger?' she asked, 'or to bury yourself alive'? Or to surrender an uncondemned spirit before the fates demand it? 'Think you the ashes or sepultured dead can feel aught of thy woe! Would you recall the dead from the reluctant fates? Why not shake off this womanish weakness and enjoy the blessings of light while you can? The very corpse lying there ought to convince you that your duty is to live!' When pressed to eat or to live, no one listens unwillingly, and the lady, thirsty after an abstinence of several days, finally permitted her obstinacy to be overcome; nor did she take her fill of nourishment with less avidity than had the maid who had surrendered first."

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWELFTH.

"But to make a long story short, you know the temptations that beset a full stomach: the soldier laid siege to her virtue with the selfsame blandishments by which he had persuaded her that she ought to live. Nor, to her modest eye, did the young man seem uncouth or wanting in address. The maid pled in his behalf and kept repeating:

Why will you fight with a passion
that to you is pleasure,
Remembering not in whose lands you
are taking your leisure?

"But why should I keep you longer in suspense? The lady observed the same abstinence when it came to this part of her body, and the victorious soldier won both of his objectives; so they lay together, not only that night, in which they pledged their vows, but also the next, and even the third, shutting the doors of the vault, of course, so that anyone, acquaintance or stranger, coming to the tomb, would be convinced that this most virtuous of wives had expired upon the body of her husband. As for the soldier, so delighted was he with the beauty of his mistress and the secrecy of the intrigue, that he purchased all the delicacies his pay permitted and smuggled them into the vault as soon as darkness fell. Meanwhile, the parents of one of the crucified criminals, observing the laxness of the watch, dragged the hanging corpse down at night and performed the last rite. The soldier was hoodwinked while absent from his post of duty, and when on the following day he caught sight of one of the crosses without its corpse, he was in terror of punishment and explained to the lady what had taken place: He would await no sentence of court-martial, but would punish his neglect of duty with his own sword! Let her prepare a place for one

about to die, let that fatal vault serve both the lover and the husband! 'Not that,' cried out the lady, no less merciful than chaste, 'the gods forbid that I should look at the same time upon the corpses of the two men dearest to me; I would rather hang the dead than slay the living!' So saying, she gave orders for the body of her husband to be lifted out of the coffin and fastened upon the vacant cross! The soldier availed himself of the expedient suggested by this very ingenious lady and next day everyone wondered how a dead man had found his way to the cross!"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND THIRTEENTH.

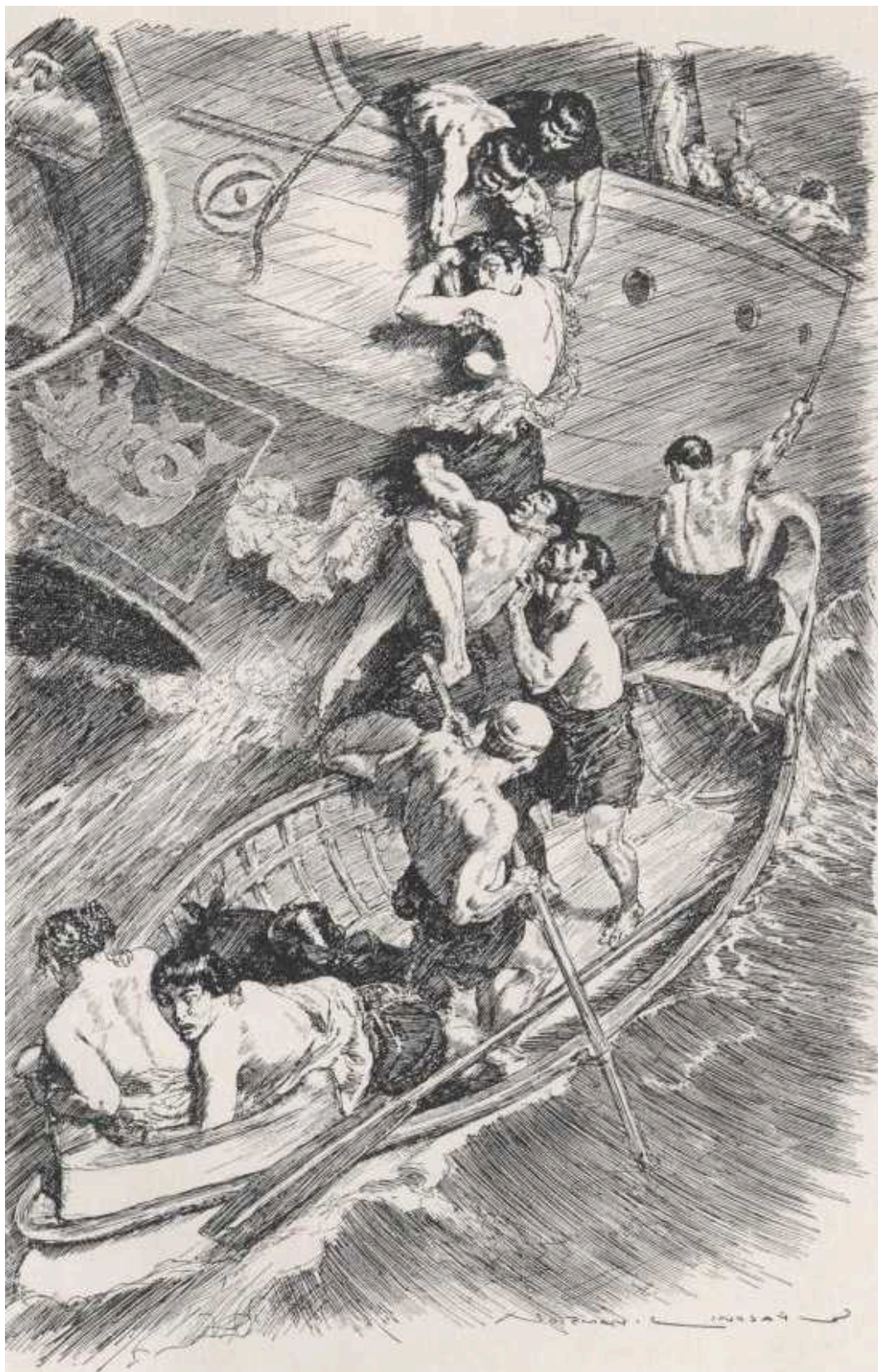
The sailors received this tale with roars of laughter, and Tryphaena blushed not a little and laid her face amorously upon Giton's neck. But Lycas did not laugh; "If that governor had been a just man," said he, shaking his head angrily, "he would have ordered the husband's body taken down and carried back into the vault, and crucified the woman." No doubt the memory of Hedyle haunted his mind, and the looting of his ship in that wanton excursion. But the terms of the treaty permitted the harboring of no old grudges and the joy which filled our hearts left no room for anger. Tryphaena was lying in Giton's lap by this time, covering his bosom with kisses one minute and rearranging the curls upon his shaven head the next. Uneasy and chagrined at this new league, I took neither food nor drink but looked askance at them both, with grim eyes. Every kiss was a wound to me, every artful blandishment which the wanton woman employed, and I could not make up my mind as to whether I was more angered at the boy for having supplanted me with my mistress, or at my mistress for debauching the boy: both were hateful to my sight, and more galling than my late servitude. And to make the matter all the more aggravating, Tryphaena would not even greet me as an acquaintance, whom she had formerly received as a lover, while Giton did not think me worthy of a "Here's-to-you" in ordinary civility, nor even speak to me in the course of the common conversation; I suppose he was afraid of reopening a tender scar at the moment when a return to her good graces had commenced to draw it together. Tears of vexation dropped upon my breast and the groan I smothered in a sigh nearly wracked my soul.

The vulture tearing; at the liver's deep
and vital parts,
That wracks our breasts and rends our

very heartstrings
Is not that bird the charming poet
sings with all his arts;
'Tis jealousy or hate that human
hearts stings.

(In spite of my ill-humor, Lycas saw how well my golden curls became me and, becoming enamoured anew, began winking his wanton eyes at me and) sought admission to my good graces upon a footing of pleasure, nor did he put on the arrogance of a master, but spoke as a friend asking a favor; (long and ardently he tried to gain his ends, but all in vain, till at last, meeting with a decisive repulse, his passion turned to fury and he tried to carry the place by storm; but Tryphaena came in unexpectedly and caught him in his wanton attempt, whereupon he was greatly upset and hastily adjusted his clothing and bolted out of the cabin. Tryphaena was fired with lust at this sight, "What was Lycas up to?" she demanded. "What was he after in that ardent assault?" She compelled me to explain, burned still more hotly at what she heard, and, recalling memories of our past familiarities, she desired me to renew our old amour, but I was worn out with so much venery and slighted her advances. She was burning up with desire by this time, and threw her arms around me in a frenzied embrace, hugging me so tightly that I uttered an involuntary cry of pain. One of her maids rushed in at this and, thinking that I was attempting to force from her mistress the very favor which I had refused her, she sprang at us and tore us apart. Thoroughly enraged at the disappointment of her lecherous passion, Tryphaena upbraided me violently, and with many threats she hurried out to find Lycas for the purpose of exasperating him further against me and of joining forces with him to be revenged upon me. Now you must know that I had formerly held a very high place in this waiting-maid's esteem, while I was prosecuting my intrigue with her mistress, and for that reason she took it very hard when she surprised me with Tryphaena, and sobbed very bitterly. I pressed her earnestly to tell me the reason for her sobs) {and after pretending to be reluctant she broke out:} "You will think no more of her than of a common prostitute if you have a drop of decent blood in your veins! You will not resort to that female catamite, if you are a man!" {This disturbed my mind but} what exercised me most was the fear that Eumolpus would find out what was going on and, being a very sarcastic

individual, might revenge my supposed injury in some poetic lampoon, (in which event his ardent zeal would without doubt expose me to ridicule, and I greatly dreaded that. But while I was debating with myself as to the best means of preventing him from getting at the facts, who should suddenly come in but the man himself; and he was not uninformed as to what had taken place, for Tryphaena had related all the particulars to Giton and had tried to indemnify herself for my repulse, at the expense of my little friend. Eumolpus was furiously angry because of all this, and all the more so as lascivious advances were in open violation of the treaty which had been signed. The minute the old fellow laid eyes upon me, he began bewailing my lot and ordered me to tell him exactly what had happened. As he was already well informed, I told him frankly of Lycas' lecherous attempt and of Tryphaena's wanton assault. When he had heard all the facts,) Eumolpus swore roundly (that he would certainly avenge us, as the Gods were just and would not suffer so many villainies to go unpunished.)



The Rescue of Tryphæna

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND FOURTEENTH.

We were still discussing this and other matters when the sea grew rough, and clouds, gathering from every quarter, obscured with darkness the light of day. The panic-stricken sailors ran to their stations and took in sail before the squall was upon them, but the gale did not drive the waves in any one direction and the helmsman lost his bearings and did not know what course to steer. At one moment the wind would set towards Sicily, but the next, the North Wind, prevailing on the Italian coast, would drive the unlucky vessel hither and yon; and, what was more dangerous than all the rain-squalls, a pall of such black density blotted out the light that the helmsman could not even see as far forward as the bow. At last, as the savage fury of the sea grew more malignant, the trembling Lycas stretched out his hands to me imploringly. "Save us from destruction, Encolpius," he shouted; "restore that sacred robe and holy rattle to the ship! Be merciful, for heaven's sake, just as you used to be!" He was still shouting when a windsquall swept him into the sea; the raging elements whirled him around and around in a terrible maelstrom and sucked him down. Tryphaena, on the other hand, was seized by her faithful servants, placed in a skiff, along with the greater part of her belongings, and saved from certain death. Embracing Giton, I wept aloud: "Did we deserve this from the gods," I cried, "to be united only in death? No! Malignant fortune grudges even that. Look! In an instant the waves will capsize the ship! Think! In an instant the sea will sever this lover's embrace! If you ever loved Encolpius truly, kiss him while yet you may and snatch this last delight from impending dissolution!" Even as I was speaking, Giton removed his garment and, creeping beneath my tunic, he stuck out his head to be kissed; then, fearing some more spiteful wave might separate us as we clung together, he passed his belt around us both. "If nothing else," he cried, "the sea will at least bear us longer, joined together, and if, in pity, it casts us up upon the same shore, some passerby may pile some stones over us, out of common human kindness, or the last

rites will be performed by the drifting sand, in spite of the angry waves." I submit to this last bond and, as though I were laid out upon my death-bed, await an end no longer dreaded. Meanwhile, accomplishing the decrees of the Fates, the storm stripped the ship of all that was left; no mast, no helm, not a rope nor an oar remained on board her; she was only a derelict, heavy and water-logged, drifting before the waves. Some fishermen hastily put off in their little boats to salvage their booty, but, seeing men alive and ready to defend their property, they changed their predatory designs into offers of help.

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND FIFTEENTH.

Just then, amid that clamor of voices we heard a peculiar noise, and from beneath the captain's cabin there came a bellowing as of some wild beast trying to get out. We then followed up the sound and discovered Eumolpus, sitting there scribbling verses upon an immense sheet of parchment! Astounded that he could find time to write poetry at death's very door, we hauled him out, in spite of his protests, and ordered him to return to his senses, but he flew into a rage at being interrupted; "Leave me alone until I finish this sentence," he bawled; "the poem labors to its birth." Ordering Giton to come to close quarters and help me drag the bellowing bard ashore, I laid hands upon the lunatic. When this job had at last been completed, we came, wet and wretched, to a fisherman's hut and refreshed ourselves somewhat with stores from the wreck, spoiled though they were by salt water, and passed a night that was almost interminable. As we were holding a council, next day, to determine to what part of the country we had best proceed, I suddenly caught sight of a human body, turning around in a gentle eddy and floating towards the shore. Stricken with melancholy, I stood still and began to brood, with wet eyes, upon the treachery of the sea. "And perhaps," said I, "a wife, safe in some far-away country of the earth, awaits this man, or a son who little dreams of storms or wrecks; or perhaps he left behind a father, whom he kissed good-by at parting! Such is the end of mortal's plans, such is the outcome of great ambitions! See how man rides the waves!" Until now, I had been sorrowing for a mere stranger, but a wave turned the face, which had undergone no change, towards the shore, and I recognized Lycas; so evil-tempered and so unrelenting but a short time before, now cast up almost at my feet! I could no longer restrain the tears, at this; I beat my breast again and yet again, with my hands. "Where

is your evil temper now?" I cried. "Where is your unbridled passion? You be there, a prey to fish and wild beasts, you who boasted but a little while ago of the strength of your command. Now you have not a single plank left of your great ship! Go on, mortals; set your hearts upon the fulfillment of great ambitions: Go on, schemers, and in your wills control for a thousand years the disposal of the wealth you got by fraud! Only yesterday this man audited the accounts of his family estate, yea, even reckoned the day he would arrive in his native land and settled it in his mind! Gods and goddesses, how far he lies from his appointed destination! But the waves of the sea are not alone in thus keeping faith with mortal men: The warrior's weapons fail him; the citizen is buried beneath the ruins of his own penates, when engaged in paying his vows to the gods; another falls from his chariot and dashes out his ardent spirit; the glutton chokes at dinner; the niggard starves from abstinence. Give the dice a fair throw and you will find shipwreck everywhere! Ah, but one overwhelmed by the waves obtains no burial! As though it matters in what manner the body, once it is dead, is consumed: by fire, by flood, by time! Do what you will, these all achieve the same end. Ah, but the beasts will mangle the body! As though fire would deal with it any more gently; when we are angry with our slaves that is the punishment which we consider the most severe. What folly it is, then, to do everything we can to prevent the grave from leaving any part of us behind {when the Fates will look out for us, event against our wills.}" (After these reflections we made ready to pay the last rites to the corpse,) and Lycas was burned upon a funeral pyre raised by the hands of enemies, while Eumolpus, fixing his eyes upon the far distance to gain inspiration, composed an epitaph for the dead man:

HIS FATE WAS UNAVOIDABLE

NO ROCK-HEWN TOMB NOR SCULPTURED MARBLE HIS,

HIS NOBLE CORPSE FIVE FEET OF EARTH RECEIVED,

HE RESTS IN PEACE BENEATH THIS HUMBLE MOUND.

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND SIXTEENTH.

We set out upon our intended journey, after this last office had been wholeheartedly performed, and, in a little while, arrived, sweating, at the top of a mountain, from which we made out, at no great distance, a town, perched upon the summit of a lofty eminence. Wanderers as we were, we had no idea what town it could be, until we learned from a caretaker that it was Crotona, a very ancient city, and once the first in Italy. When we earnestly inquired, upon learning this, what men inhabited such historic ground, and the nature of the business in which they were principally engaged, now that their wealth had been dissipated by the oft recurring wars, "My friends," replied he, "if you are men of business, change your plans and seek out some other conservative road to a livelihood, but if you can play the part of men of great culture, always ready with a lie, you are on the straight road to riches: The study of literature is held in no estimation in that city, eloquence has no niche there, economy and decent standards of morality come into no reward of honor there; you must know that every man whom you will meet in that city belongs to one of two factions; they either 'take-in,' or else they are 'taken-in.' No one brings up children in that city, for the reason that no one who has heirs is invited to dinner or admitted to the games; such an one is deprived of all enjoyments and must lurk with the rabble. On the other hand, those who have never married a wife, or those who have no near relatives, attain to the very highest honors; in other words, they are the only ones who are considered soldierly, or the bravest of the brave, or even good. You will see a town which resembles the fields in time of pestilence," he continued, "in which there is nothing but carcasses to be torn at and carrion crows tearing at them."



Corax

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND SEVENTEENTH.

Eumolpus, who had a deeper insight, turned this state of affairs over in his mind and declared that he was not displeased with a prospect of that kind. I thought the old fellow was joking in the care-free way of poets, until he complained, "If I could only put up a better front! I mean that I wish my clothing was in better taste, that my jewelry was more expensive; all this would lend color to my deception: I would not carry this scrip, by Hercules, I would not I would lead you all to great riches!" For my part, I undertook to supply whatever my companion in robbery had need of, provided he would be satisfied with the garment, and with whatever spoils the villa of Lycurgus had yielded when we robbed it; as for money against present needs, the Mother of the Gods would see to that, out of regard to her own good name! "Well, what's to prevent our putting on an extravaganza?" demanded Eumolpus. "Make me the master if the business appeals to you." No one ventured to condemn a scheme by which he could lose nothing, and so, that the lie would be kept safe among us all, we swore a solemn oath, the words of which were dictated by Eumolpus, to endure fire, chains, flogging, death by the sword, and whatever else Eumolpus might demand of us, just like regular gladiators! After the oath had been taken, we paid our respects to our master with pretended servility, and were informed that Eumolpus had lost a son, a young man of great eloquence and promise, and that it was for this reason the poor old man had left his native land that he might not see the companions and clients of his son, nor even his tomb, which was the cause of his daily tears. To this misfortune a recent shipwreck had been added, in which he had lost upwards of two millions of sesterces; not that he minded the loss but, destitute of a train of servants he could not keep up his proper dignity! Furthermore, he had, invested in Africa, thirty millions of sesterces in estates and bonds; such a horde of his slaves was scattered over the fields of Numidia that he could have even sacked Carthage! We demanded that Eumolpus cough frequently, to further

this scheme, that he have trouble with his stomach and find fault with all the food when in company, that he keep talking of gold and silver and estates, the incomes from which were not what they should be, and of the everlasting unproductiveness of the soil; that he cast up his accounts daily, that he revise the terms of his will monthly, and, for fear any detail should be lacking to make the farce complete, he was to use the wrong names whenever he wished to summon any of us, so that it would be plain to all that the master had in mind some who were not present. When everything had been thus provided for, we offered a prayer to the gods "that the matter might turn out well and happily," and took to the road. But Giton could not bear up under his unaccustomed load, and the hired servant Corax, a shirker of work, often put down his own load and cursed our haste, swearing that he would either throw his packs away or run away with his load. "What do you take me for, a beast of burden?" he grumbled, "or a scow for carrying stone? I hired out to do the work of a man, not that of a pack-horse, and I'm as free as you are, even if my father did leave me poor!" Not satisfied with swearing, he lifted up his leg from time to time and filled the road with an obscene noise and a filthy stench. Giton laughed at his impudence and imitated every explosion with his lips, {but Eumolpus relapsed into his usual vein, even in spite of this.}

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND EIGHTEENTH.

"Young men," said he, "many are they who have been seduced by poetry; for, the instant a man has composed a verse in feet, and has woven a more delicate meaning into it by means of circumlocutions, he straightway concludes that he has scaled Helicon! Take those who are worn out by the distressing detail of the legal profession, for example: they often seek sanctuary in the tranquillity of poetry, as a more sheltered haven, believing themselves able more easily to compose a poem than a rebuttal charged with scintillating epigrams! But a more highly cultivated mind loves not this conceited affectation, nor can it either conceive or bring forth, unless it has been steeped in the vast flood of literature. Every word that is what I would call 'low,' ought to be avoided, and phrases far removed from plebeian usage should be chosen. Let 'Ye rabble rout avaunt,' be your rule. In addition, care should be exercised in preventing the epigrams from standing out from the body of the speech; they should gleam with the brilliancy woven into the fabric. Homer is an example, and the lyric poets, and our Roman Virgil, and the exquisite propriety of Horace. Either the others did not discover the road that leads to poetry, or, having seen, they feared to tread it. Whoever attempts that mighty theme, the civil war, for instance, will sink under the load unless he is saturated with literature. Events, past and passing, ought not to be merely recorded in verse, the historian will deal with them far better; by means of circumlocutions and the intervention of the immortals, the free spirit, wracked by the search for epigrams having a mythological illusion, should plunge headlong and appear as the prophecy of a mind inspired rather than the attested faith of scrupulous exactitude in speech. This hasty composition may please you, even though it has not yet received its final polishing:"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND NINETEENTH.

"The conquering Roman now held the
whole world in his sway,
The ocean, the land; where the sun
shone by day or the moon
Gleamed by night: but unsated was
he. And the seas
Were roiled by the weight of his
deep-laden keels; if a bay
Lay hidden beyond, or a land which
might yield yellow gold
'Twas held as a foe. While the
struggle for treasure went on
The fates were preparing the horrors
and scourges of war.
Amusements enjoyed by the vulgar
no longer can charm
Nor pleasures worn threadbare by use
of the plebeian mob.
The bronzes of Corinth are praised by
the soldier at sea;
And glittering gems sought in earth,
vie with purple of Tyre;
Numidia curses her here, there, the
exquisite silks
Of China; Arabia's people have
stripped their own fields.
Behold other woes and calamities
outraging peace!

Wild beasts, in the forest are hunted,
for gold; and remote
African hammon is covered by
beaters, for fear
Some beast that slays men with his
teeth shall escape, for by that
His value to men is enhanced! The
vessels receive
Strange ravening monsters; the tiger
behind gilded bars
And pacing his cage is transported to
Rome, that his jaws
May drip with the life blood of men
to the plaudits of men
Oh shame! To point out our
impending destruction; the crime
Of Persia enacted anew; in his
puberty's bloom
The man child is kidnapped;
surrenders his powers to the knife,
Is forced to the calling of Venus;
delayed and hedged round
The hurrying passage of life's finest
years is held back
And Nature seeks Nature but finds
herself not. Everywhere
These frail-limbed and mincing
effeminates, flowing of locks,
Bedecked with an infinite number of
garments of silk
Whose names ever change, the
wantons and lechers to snare,
Are eagerly welcomed! From African
soil now behold
The citron-wood tables; their well-
burnished surface reflects
Our Tyrian purples and slaves by the

horde, and whose spots
Resemble the gold that is cheaper
than they and ensnare
Extravagance. Sterile and ignobly
prized is the wood
But round it is gathered a company
sodden with wine;
And soldiers of fortune whose
weapons have rusted, devour
The spoils of the world. Art caters to
appetite. Wrasse
From Sicily brought to their table,
alive in his own Sea water.
The oysters from Lucrine's shore
torn, at the feast
Are served to make famous the host;
and the appetite, cloyed,
To tempt by extravagance. Phasis has
now been despoiled
Of birds, its littoral silent, no sound
there is heard
Save only the wind as it rustles
among the last leaves.
Corruption no less vile is seen in the
campus of Mars,
Our quirites are bribed; and for
plunder and promise of gain
Their votes they will alter. The people
is venal; corrupt
The Senate; support has its price!
And the freedom and worth
Of age is decayed, scattered largesse
now governs their power;
Corrupted by gold, even dignity lies
in the dust.
Cato defeated and hooted by mobs,
but the victor

Is sadder, ashamed to have taken the
rods from a Cato:
In this lay the shame of the nation
and character's downfall,
'Twas not the defeat of a man! No!
The power and the glory
Of Rome were brought low;
represented in him was the honor
Of sturdy Republican Rome. So,
abandoned and wretched,
The city has purchased dishonor: has
purchased herself!
Despoiled by herself, no avenger to
wipe out the stigma
Twin maelstroms of debt and of usury
suck down the commons.
No home with clear title, no citizen
free from a mortgage,
But as some slow wasting disease all
unheralded fastens
Its hold on the vitals, destroying the
vigor of manhood,
So, fear of the evils impending,
impels them to madness.
Despair turns to violence, luxury's
ravages needs must
Repaired be by bloodshed, for
indigence safely can venture.
Can art or sane reason rouse
wallowing Rome from the offal
And break the voluptuous slumber in
which she is sunken?
Or must it be fury and war and the
blood-lust of daggers?"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWENTIETH.

"Three chieftains did fortune bring
forth, whom the fury of battles
Destroyed; and interred, each one
under a mountain of weapons;
The Parthian has Crassus, Pompeius
the Great by the waters
Of Egypt lies. Julius, ungrateful
Rome stained with his life blood.
And earth has divided their ashes,
unable to suffer
The weight of so many tombs. These
are the wages of glory!
There lies between Naples and Great
Puteoli, a chasm
Deep cloven, and Cocytus churns
there his current; the vapor
In fury escapes from the gorge with
that lethal spray laden.
No green in the aututun is there, no
grass gladdens the meadow,
The supple twigs never resound with
the twittering singing
Of birds in the Springtime. But chaos,
volcanic black boulders
Of pumice lie Happy within their
drear setting of cypress.
Amidst these infernal surroundings
the ruler of Hades

Uplifted his head by the funeral
flames silhouetted
And sprinkled with white from the
ashes of corpses; and challenged
Winged Fortune in words such as
these: 'Oh thou fickle controller
Of things upon earth and in heaven,
security's foeman,
Oh Chance! Oh thou lover eternally
faithful to change, and
Possession's betrayer, dost own
thyself crushed by the power
Of Rome? Canst not raise up the
tottering mass to its downfall
Its strength the young manhood of
Rome now despises, and staggers
In bearing the booty heaped up by its
efforts: behold how
They lavish their spoils! Wealth run
mad now brings down their
destruction.
They build out of gold and their
palaces reach to the heavens;
The sea is expelled by their moles
and their pastures are oceans;
They war against Nature in changing
the state of creation.
They threaten my kingdom! Earth
yawns with their tunnels deep driven
To furnish the stone for their
madmen's foundations; already
The mountains are hollowed and now
but re-echoing caverns;
While man quarries marble to serve
his vainglorious purpose
The spirits infernal confess that they
hope to win Heaven!

Arise, then, O Chance, change thy
countenance peaceful to warlike
And harry the Romans, consign to my
kingdom the fallen.

Ah, long is it now since my lips were
with blood cooled and moistened,
Nor has my Tisiphone bathed her
blood-lusting body
Since Sulla's sword drank to repletion
and earth's bristling harvest
Grew ripe upon blood and thrust up
to the light of the sunshine!"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWENTY-FIRST.

"He spake ... and attempted to clasp
the right hand of Fortuna,
But ruptured the crust of the earth,
deeply cloven, asunder.
Then from her capricious heart
Fortune made answer: 'O father
Whom Cocytus' deepest abysses
obey, if to forecast
The future I may, without fear, thy
petition shall prosper;
For no less consuming the anger that
wars in this bosom,
The flame no less poignant, that
burns to my marrow All favors
I gave to the bulwarks of Rome, now,
I hate them. My
Gifts I repent! The same God who
built up their dominion
Shall bring down destruction upon it.
In burning their manhood
My heart shall delight and its blood-
lust shall slake with their slaughter.
Now Philippi's field I can see strewn
with dead of two battles
And Thessaly's funeral pyres and
Iberia mourning.
Already the clangor of arms thrills
my ears, and rings loudly:

Thou, Lybian Nile, I can see now thy
barriers groaning
And Actium's gulf and Apollo's darts
quailing the warriors!
Then, open thy thirsty dominions and
summon fresh spirits;
For scarce will the ferryman's
strength be sufficient to carry
The souls of the dead in his skiff: 'tis
a fleet that is needed!
Thou, Pallid Tisiphone, slake with
wide ruin, thy thirsting
And tear ghastly wounds: mangled
earth sinks to hell and the spirits."

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWENTY-SECOND.

"But scarce had she finished, when
trembled the clouds; and a gleaming
Bright flash of Jove's lightning
transfixed them with flame and was
gone.

The Lord of the Shades blanched
with fear, at this bolt of his brother's,
Sank back, and drew closely together
the gorge in Earth's bosom.

By auspices straightway the slaughter
of men and the evils

Impending are shown by the gods.
Here, the Titan unsightly

Blood red, veils his face with a
twilight; on strife fratricidal

Already he gazed, thou hadst
thought! There, silvery Cynthia

Obscuring her face at the full, denied
light to the outrage.

The mountain crests riven by rock-
slides roll thundering downward

And wandering rivers, to rivulets
shrunk, writhed no longer

Familiar marges between. With the
clangor of armor

The heavens resound; from the stars
wafts the thrill of a trumpet

Sounding the call to arms. AEtna,

now roused to eruption
Unwonted, darts flashes of flame to
the clouds. Flitting phantoms
Appear midst the tombs and unburied
bones, gibbering menace
A comet, strange stars in its diadem,
leads a procession
And reddens the skies with its fire.
Showers of blood fall from heaven
These portents the Deity shortly
fulfilled! For now Caesar
Forsook vacillation and, spurred by
the love of revenge, sheathed
The Gallic sword; brandished the
brand that proclaimed civil warfare.
There, high in the Alps, where the
crag, by a Greek god once trodden,
Slope down and permit of approach,
is a spot ever sacred
To Hercules' altar; the winter with
frozen snow seals it
And rears to the heavens a summit
eternally hoary,
As though the sky there had slipped
down: no warmth from the sunbeams,
No breath from the Springtime can
soften the pile's wintry rigor
Nor slacken the frost chains that bind;
and its menacing shoulders
The weight of the world could
sustain. With victorious legions
These crests Caesar trod and selected
a camp. Gazing downwards
On Italy's plains rolling far, from the
top of the mountain,
He lifted both hands to the heavens,
his voice rose in prayer:

'Omnipotent Jove, and thou, refuge of
Saturn whose glory
Was brightened by feats of my armies
and crowned with my triumphs,
Bear witness! Unwillingly summon I
Mars to these armies,
Unwillingly draw I the sword! But
injustice compels me.
While enemy blood dyes the Rhine
and the Alps are held firmly
Repulsing a second assault of the
Gauls on our city,
She dubs me an outcast! And Victory
makes me an exile!
To triumphs three score, and defeats
of the Germans, my treason
I trace! How can they fear my glory
or see in my battles
A menace? But hirelings, and vile, to
whom my Rome is but a
Stepmother! Methinks that no craven
this sword arm shall hamper
And take not a stroke in repost. On to
victory, comrades,
While anger seethes hot. With the
sword we will seek a decision
The doom lowering down is a peril to
all, and the treason.
My gratitude owe I to you, not alone
have I conquered!
Since punishment waits by our
trophies and victory merits
Disgrace, then let Chance cast the
lots. Raise the standard of battle;
Again take your swords. Well I know
that my cause is accomplished
Amidst such armed warriors I know

that I cannot be beaten.'
While yet the words echoed, from
heaven the bird of Apollo
Vouchsafed a good omen and beat
with his pinions the ether.
From out of the left of a gloomy
grove strange voices sounded
And flame flashed thereafter! The sun
gleamed with brighter refulgence
Unwonted, his face in a halo of
golden flame shining."

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWENTY-THIRD.

"By omens emboldened, to follow,
the battle-flags, Caesar
Commanded; and boldly led on down
the perilous pathway.
The footing, firm-fettered by frost
chains and ice, did not hinder
At first, but lay silent, the kindly cold
masking its grimness;
But, after the squadrons of cavalry
shattered the clouds, bound
By ice, and the trembling steeds
crushed in the mail of the rivers,
Then, melted the snows! And soon
torrents newborn, from the heights of
The mountains rush down: but these
also, as if by commandment
Grow rigid, and, turn into ice, in their
headlong rush downwards!
Now, that which rushed madly a
moment before, must be hacked
through!
But now, it was treacherous, baffling
their steps and their footing
Deceiving; and men, horses, arms,
fall in heaps, in confusion.
And see! Now the clouds, by an icy
gale smitten, their burden
Discharge! Lo! the gusts of the

whirlwind swirl fiercely about them;
The sky in convulsions, with swollen
hail buffets them sorely.
Already the clouds themselves
rupture and smother their weapons,
An avalanche icy roars down like a
billow of ocean;
Earth lay overwhelmed by the drifts
of the snow and the planets
Of heaven are blotted from sight;
overwhelmed are the rivers
That cling to their banks, but
unconquered is Caesar! His javelin
He leans on and scrunches with firm
step a passage the bristling
Grim ice fields across! As, spurred on
by the lust, of adventure
Amphitryon's offspring came striding
the Caucasus slopes down;
Or Jupiter's menacing mien as, from
lofty Olympus
He leaped, the doomed giants to
crush and to scatter their weapons.
While Caesar in anger the swelling
peaks treads down, winged rumor
In terror flies forth and on beating
wings seeks the high summit
Of Palatine tall: every image she
rocks with her message
Announcing this thunderbolt Roman!
Already, the ocean
Is tossing his fleets! Now his cavalry,
reeking with German
Gore, pours from the Alps! Slaughter,
bloodshed, and weapons
The red panorama of war is unrolled
to their vision!

By terror their hearts are divided: two
counsels perplex them!
One chooses by land to seek flight: to
another, the water
Appeals, and the sea than his own
land is safer! Another
Will stand to his arms and advantage
extort from Fate's mandate.
The depth of their fear marks the
length of their flight! In confusion
The people itself--shameful
spectacle--driven by terror
Is led to abandon the city. Rome
glories in fleeing!
The Quirites from battle blench!
Cowed by the breath of a rumor
Relinquished their firesides to
mourning! One citizen, palsied
With terror, his children embraces:
another, his penates
Conceals in his bosom; then,
weeping, takes leave of his threshold
And slaughters the distant invader--
with curses! Their spouses
Some clasp to their sorrow-wracked
bosoms! Youths carry their fathers
Bowed down with old age, uninured
to the bearing of burdens.
They seize what they dread to lose
most. Inexperience drags all
Its chattels to camp and to battle: as,
when powerful Auster
Piles up the churned waters and
tumbles them: never a yard-arm
Nor rudder to answer the hand, here,
one fashions a life-raft
Of pine planks, another steers into

some bay on a lee shore,
Another will crack on and run from
the gale and to Fortune
Trust all! But why sorrow for trifles?
The consuls, with Pompey
The Great--he, the terror of Pontus, of
savage Hydaspes
Explorer, the reef that wrecked
pirates, caused Jove to turn livid,
When thrice was a triumph decreed
him, whom Pontus' vexed water
And pacified billows of Bosphorus
worshipped! Disgraceful their
Flight! Title and glory forsaking!
Now Fortune capricious
Looks down on the back of great
Pompey retreating in terror!"

CHAPTER THE ONE HUNDRED AND TWENTY-FOURTH.

"So great a misfortune disrupted the
concord of heaven
And gods swelled the rout in their
panic! Behold through creation
The gentle divinities flee from the
ravaging earth; in
Their loathing they turn from
humanity, doomed to destruction!
And first of all, Peace, with her
snowy white arms, hides her visage
Defeated, her helmet beneath and,
abandoning earth, flees
To seek out the realm of implacable
Dis, as a refuge
Meek Faith her companion, and
Justice with locks loosely flowing,
And Concord, in tears, and her
raiment in tatters, attend her.
The minions of Pluto pour forth from
the portals of darkness
That yawn: the serpent-haired Fury,
Bellona the Savage,
Megoera with firebrands, destruction,
and treachery, livid
Death's likeness! Among them is
Frenzy, as, free, with her lashings
Snapped short, she now raises her
gory head, shielding her features

Deep scarred by innumerable wounds
'neath her helmet blood-clotted.
Her left arm she guards with a battle-
scarred shield scored by weapons,
And numberless spear-heads protrude
from its surface: her right hand
A flaming torch brandishes, kindling
a flame that will burn up
The world! Now the gods are on earth
and the skies note their absence;
The planets disordered their orbits
attempt! Into factions
The heavens divide; first Dione
espouses the cause of
Her Caesar. Minerva next steps to her
side and the great son
Of Ares, his mighty spear
brandishing! Phoebus espouses
The cause of Great Pompey: his sister
and Mercury also
And Hercules like unto him in his
travels and labors.
The trumpets call! Discord her
Stygian head lifts to heaven
Her tresses disheveled, her features
with clotted blood covered,
Tears pour from her bruised eyes, her
iron fangs thick coated with rust,
Her tongue distils poison, her features
are haloed with serpents,
Her hideous bosom is visible under
her tatters,
A torch with a blood red flame waves
from her tremulous right hand.
Emerging from Cocytus dark and
from Tartarus murky
She strode to the crests of the

Apennines noble, the prospect
Of earth to survey, spread before her
the world panorama
Its shores and the armies that march
on its surface: these words then
Burst out of her bosom malignant: 'To
arms, now, ye nations,
While anger seethes hot, seize your
arms, set the torch to the cities,
Who skulks now is lost; neither
woman nor child nor the aged
Bowed down with their years shall
find quarter: the whole world will
tremble
And rooftrees themselves shall crash
down and take part in the struggle.
Marcellus, hold firm for the law! And
thou, Curio, madden
The rabble! Thou, Lentulus, strive not
to check valiant Ares!
Thou, Cesar divine, why delayest
thou now thine invasion?
Why smash not the gates, why not
level the walls of the cities,
Their treasures to pillage? Thou,
Magnus, dost not know the secret
Of holding the hills of Rome? Take
thou the walls of Dyrrachium,
Let Thessaly's harbors be dyed with
the blood of the Romans!
On earth was obeyed every detail of
Discord's commandment."

When Eumolpus had, with great volubility, poured out this flood of words, we came at last to Crotona. Here we refreshed ourselves at a mean inn, but on the following day we went in search of more imposing lodgings and fell in with a crowd of legacy hunters who were very curious as to the

class of society to which we belonged and as to whence we had come. Thereupon, in accord with our mutual understanding, such ready answers did we make as to who we might be or whence we had come that we gave them no cause for doubt. They immediately fell to wrangling in their desire to heap their own riches upon Eumolpus and every fortune-hunter solicited his favor with presents.

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— VOLUME 04 : ESCAPE BY SEA ***

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